

Chocolate Banana Bread

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Soft and moist, with chocolate chips throughout and a little cinnamon, this banana bread is a lovely way to use ripe bananas.

Makes 1 loaf, approximately 10–12 slices · Prep 15 min · Cook 1 h

INGREDIENTS

- 8 tbsp butter (approximately 115 g), plus extra for greasing
- 1 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- ¼ cup buttermilk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3 ripe bananas, mashed
- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- ½ cup semi-sweet chocolate chips
- Approximately 2 tbsp roughly chopped pecans, optional
- 4–5 tbsp Nutella, for topping, optional

METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 175°C. Butter a loaf pan and line it with baking paper, leaving an overhang to help lift out the loaf.
2. Melt the butter, then let it cool slightly. Combine with the sugar in a mixing bowl and beat until well mixed.
3. Add the eggs, one at a time, mixing after each addition. Add the buttermilk and vanilla extract.
4. Stir in the mashed bananas.
5. In a separate bowl, combine the flour, baking soda, salt and cinnamon. Add to the wet mixture and mix gently, just until no dry flour remains.
6. Fold in the chocolate chips and the pecans, if using. Pour the batter into the prepared loaf pan and smooth the top.
7. Bake for approximately 60 minutes, or until a toothpick inserted into the centre comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs. Check in more than one spot, as melted chocolate may mark the toothpick.
8. Leave to cool in the pan for 20 minutes, then carefully transfer to a serving plate or wire rack.
9. If using Nutella, spoon it into a piping bag and snip off the tip. Starting at one corner, pipe it in a zigzag pattern across the loaf to cover the top. Alternatively, leave the top plain.

Tip

Use very ripe bananas. They bring sweetness, flavour and moisture.

Watch Nell make it